VENTURELENS

Sample Startup Pitch Deck

EcoCart — Sustainable Commerce for Everyday Shopping

Founder: Aanya Sharma

Category: E-commerce / Sustainability

Funding Stage: Seed

Funding Ask: INR 1.5 crore

This is a fictional sample created for testing PDF upload and text extraction in the VentureLens project.

1. Executive Summary

EcoCart is a fictional startup building an online marketplace for everyday products with lower environmental impact. It helps customers discover reusable, refillable, recycled, and locally produced goods. EcoCart plans to earn revenue through product commissions, seller subscriptions, and selected private-label products.

2. Problem

Consumers who want to make sustainable purchases often struggle to identify trustworthy products, compare environmental claims, and find affordable alternatives. Small sustainable brands also have difficulty reaching customers without spending heavily on marketing.

3. Solution

EcoCart combines curated product listings, seller verification, sustainability information, customer reviews, and delivery options. The platform aims to make sustainable products easier to discover without requiring customers to visit many separate websites.

4. Market Opportunity

The initial target market is urban Indian consumers aged 20 to 40 who shop online and are interested in sustainable living. The first launch cities are Bengaluru, Hyderabad, and Pune. The company will validate demand through customer interviews, pilot campaigns, repeat-purchase rates, and seller onboarding.

5. Business Model

EcoCart expects to earn a 12 percent commission on completed orders, monthly subscriptions from premium sellers, and margins on selected private-label products. These are planning assumptions, not validated results.

6. Traction and Validation

In this fictional example, EcoCart has completed a small pilot with 25 sellers and 1,200 registered users. It reports 320 monthly active customers and INR 8 lakh in monthly gross merchandise value. These figures are illustrative and have not been independently verified.

7. Financial Snapshot

The fictional startup estimates yearly revenue of INR 48 lakh, monthly operating expenses of INR 6 lakh, and a funding requirement of INR 1.5 crore. The company plans to use funding for product development, seller acquisition, customer marketing, and logistics partnerships. Financial figures are illustrative.

8. Competition

Potential alternatives include general e-commerce marketplaces, specialist sustainable-product stores, and direct-to-consumer brands. EcoCart intends to differentiate itself through curated selection, transparent seller information, and a simple customer experience. Competitive advantage remains to be demonstrated.

9. Go-to-Market Plan

The proposed launch plan includes partnerships with sustainable brands, campus and community campaigns, creator collaborations, referral incentives, and targeted digital marketing. The team will measure customer acquisition cost, conversion rate, order frequency, gross margin, and retention.

10. Risks and Mitigation

Key risks include customer willingness to pay, unreliable sustainability claims, high delivery costs, low repeat purchase, and competition from established marketplaces. Proposed mitigations include seller verification, small-city pilots, clear product information, and regular unit-economics reviews.

11. Team

The fictional founding team consists of Aanya Sharma, a product and operations lead, and Rohan Mehta, a technology lead. The sample does not represent a real company or real people.

12. Funding Request and Milestones

EcoCart is seeking INR 1.5 crore in seed funding for an estimated 18-month runway. Proposed milestones include 500 active sellers, 25,000 registered users, improved repeat purchases, and launch in three cities. These are targets rather than guaranteed outcomes.

Testing note: This document contains selectable text, so PDFBox text extraction should be able to read it. All company details and metrics are fictional.